



2024 TRIAL HIGHER SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION

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Centre Number

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Student Number

English Extension 1

Afternoon Session
Wednesday, 14 August 2024

General Instructions

- Reading time – 10 minutes
- Working time – 2 hours
- Write using black pen
- Write your Centre Number and Student Number at the top of this page

Total marks:
50

Section I – 25 marks (pages 2–5)

- Attempt Question 1
- Allow about 1 hour for this section

Section II – 25 marks (pages 6–15)

- Attempt ONE question from Questions 2 (a) – 2 (e)
- Allow about 1 hour for this section

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Section I – Common Module – Literary Worlds

25 marks

Attempt Question 1

Allow about 1 hour for this section

Answer the question in a SEPARATE writing booklet. EXTRA writing booklets are available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate an understanding of the ideas and values of Literary Worlds and how they are shaped and reflected in texts
 - craft a sustained composition appropriate to the question, demonstrating control of the use of language
-

Question 1 (25 marks)

Carefully read Text 1 and Text 2.

Drawing closely on the two extracts, compose a personal essay or discursive response exploring the purpose of literary worlds and the role of perspective in provoking new ways of thinking.

Text 1 – Article extract

Set on the International Space Station, Samantha Harvey's 'Orbital' reveals how small and large our world really is.

I can't be the only traveller to gaze out of an airplane window, see the frothed clouds below, and reflect that this now routine astonishment was not offered to Blake, Melville, Tolstoy, Dickinson. Proust's narrator bursts into tears when he sees a plane and imagines what the pilot sees; Virginia Woolf wrote an extraordinary essay in which she imagines London as seen from a pilot's cockpit. But, like their literary predecessors, they were never up there to see the view for themselves. And these are precisely the writers, you feel, who should have been granted access to the real thing—the cosmic artificers, the poets and novelists who moved naturally from the mundane to the massive, who saw God and knew death and narrated time, who sensed that, beyond this “mundane egg” (Blake), “This World is not Conclusion” (Dickinson).

In the nineteen-sixties, there came a new astonishment, followed by its routinization. Bill Anders's “Earthrise” picture, taken on the Apollo 8 moon mission, in 1968, presented the Earth, for the first time, as we see the moon: gibbous, squashed, half shrouded in darkness, and almost ponderously ludic, as if playing sluggish peekaboo. The foreground of the picture, which shows a slip of the moon's firm landscape, made the perspective only more vertiginous. Apollo 17's “Blue Marble,” from 1972, was oddly reassuring, the blue-and-green orb resembling both the swirled marbles of childhood and the illuminated globes in toy shops; when we had imagined the world from space, maybe this was what we had seen in our mind's eye. Even this marvel eventually turned habitual, and those famous photographs became posters for dorms and waiting rooms. Voyager 1's image from 1990, of our world seen as a

Question 1 continues on page 3

Question 1 (continued)

tiny blue dot from nearly four billion miles away, is, as Carl Sagan suggested, salutarily humbling; it has been followed by similarly minuscule transfigurations, visual scrapings from Mars and Saturn. But most of us don't live as if humbled. Whether, in these beautiful images, our world seems large or tiny, central or radically decentered, what is truly remarkable is how quickly our wonderment goes back to sleep. How many of us give much of a thought to, say, the hovering H of the International Space Station, which orbits the Earth sixteen times a day as we go about our lives, some two hundred and fifty miles below it? And how many novelists have bothered to think through what life might be like for the humans trying to exist in this hurtling cubicle? To describe in words what our glowing Earth might look like from the portholes of some flimsy ship would be a statement of faith in what words can uniquely do.

JAMES WOOD

Circling the Planet, Looking for God

The New Yorker, December 18, 2023

<https://www.newyorker.com/magazine/2023/12/25/orbital-samantha-harvey-book-review>

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Question 1 continues on page 4

Question 1 (continued)

Text 2 – Novel extract

Roman wakes early. He sloughs off his sleeping bag and swims in the dark to the lab window. Where are we, where are we? Where on earth. It's night and there's land. Into view edges a giant city nebula among reddish-rust-nothing; no, two cities, Johannesburg and Pretoria locked together like a binary star. Just beyond the hoop of the atmosphere is the sun, and in the next minute it will clear the horizon and flood the earth, and dawn will come and go in a matter of seconds before daylight is everywhere at once. Central and East Africa suddenly bright and hot.

Today is his four hundredth and thirty-fourth day in space, a tally arrived at over three different missions. He keeps close count. Of this mission it's day eighty-eight. In a single nine-month mission there are in total roughly five hundred and forty hours of morning exercise. Five hundred morning and afternoon meetings with the American, European and Russian crews on the ground. Four thousand three hundred and twenty sunrises, four thousand three hundred and twenty sunsets. Almost one hundred and eight million miles travelled. Auroras, hurricanes, storms – their numbers unknown but their occurrence certain. Nine full cycles, of course, of the moon, their silver companion moving placidly through its phases while the days go awry. But all the same the moon seen several times a day and sometimes in strange distortion.

To his tally kept on a piece of paper in his crew quarters, Roman will add the eighty-eighth line. Not to wish the time away but to try to tether it to something countable. Otherwise – otherwise the centre drifts. Space shreds time to pieces. They were told this in training: keep a tally each day when you wake, tell yourself this is the morning of a new day. Be clear with yourself on this matter. This is the morning of a new day.

And so it is, but in this new day they'll circle the earth sixteen times. They'll see sixteen sunrises and sixteen sunsets, sixteen days and sixteen nights. Roman clasps the handrail by the window to steady himself; the southern hemisphere stars are fleeting away. You're bound to Coordinated Universal Time, ground crews tell them. Be clear with yourself on this matter, always clear. Look often at your watch to anchor your mind, tell yourself when you wake up: this is the morning of a new day.

And so it is. But it's a day of five continents and of autumn and spring, glaciers and deserts, wildernesses and warzones. In their rotations around the earth in accumulations of light and dark in the baffling arithmetic of thrust and attitude and speed and sensors, the whip-crack of morning arrives every ninety minutes. They like these days when the brief bloom of daybreak outside coincides with their own.

In this last minute of darkness the moon is near-full and low to the glow of atmosphere. It's as if night has no idea it's about to be obliterated by day. Roman has a sense of himself a few months hence staring from his bedroom window at home, moving aside his wife's array of dried – and to him unnameable – flowers, forcing open the condensated and stiff casement, leaning into the Moscow air, and seeing it, the same moon, like a souvenir he's brought back from a holiday somewhere exotic.

Question 1 continues on page 5

Question 1 (continued)

But it's just for a moment and then the sight of this moon from the space station – lying squashed and low beyond the atmosphere, not really above them but across, like an equal – is everything, and that brief comprehension he had of his bedroom, his home, is gone. There was a lesson at school about the painting *Las Meninas*, when Shaun was fifteen. It was about how the painting disoriented its viewer and left them not knowing what it was they were looking at.

It's a painting inside a painting, his teacher had said – look closely. Look here. Velázquez, the artist, is in the painting, at his easel, painting a painting, and what he's painting is the king and queen, but they're outside of the painting, where we are, looking in, and the only way we know they're there is because we can see their reflection in a mirror directly in front of us. What the king and queen are looking at is what we're looking at – their daughter and her ladies-in-waiting, which is what the painting is called – *Las Meninas*, 'The Ladies-in-Waiting'. So what is the real subject of this painting – the king and queen (who are being painted and whose white reflected faces, though small, are in the centre background), their daughter (who is the star in the middle, so bright and blonde in the gloom), her ladies-(and dwarves and chaperones and dog) in-waiting, the furtive man mid-stride in the doorway in the background who seems to be bringing a message, Velázquez (whose presence as the painter is declared by the fact of him being in the painting, at his easel painting what is a picture of the king and queen but what also might be *Las Meninas* itself), or is it us, the viewers, who occupy the same position as the king and queen, who are looking in, and who are being looked at by both Velázquez and the infant princess and, in reflection, by the king and queen? Or, is the subject art itself (which is a set of illusions and tricks and artifices within life), or life itself (which is a set of illusions and tricks and artifices within a consciousness that is trying to understand life through perceptions and dreams and art)?

Or – the teacher said – is it just a painting about nothing? Just a room with some people in it and a mirror?

SAMANTHA HARVEY

Orbital, Atlantic Monthly Press, 2023

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End of Question 1

Section II – Electives

25 marks

Attempt ONE question from Questions 2 (a) – 2 (e)

Allow about 1 hour for this section

Answer the question in a SEPARATE writing booklet. EXTRA writing booklets are available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate an understanding of the ideas and values of Literary Worlds and how they are shaped and reflected in texts
 - craft a sustained composition appropriate to the question, demonstrating control of the use of language
-

Question 2 (a) – Elective 1: Literary Homelands (25 marks)

Read the stimulus provided below.

Evaluate how ideas in the stimulus relate to the increasingly complex, uncertain and/or changing worlds depicted in Literary Homelands.

In your response, refer to TWO of your prescribed texts and ONE other text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts for Literary Homelands are listed on page 7.

“One of the functions of art,” Ursula K. Le Guin observed in contemplating art, storytelling, and the power of language to transform and redeem, “is to give people the words to know their own experience... Storytelling is a tool for knowing who we are and what we want.”

Because self-knowledge is the most difficult of the arts of living, because understanding ourselves is a prerequisite for understanding anybody else, and because we can hardly fathom the reality of another without first plumbing our own depths, art is what makes us not only human but humane.

MARIA POPOVA

Iris Murdoch on Storytelling, Why Art is essential for democracy, and the key to good writing,

The Marginalian

<https://www.themarginalian.org/2018/07/18/iris-murdoch-existentialists-mystics-philosophy-literature-art/>

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Question 2 (a) continues on page 7

Question 2 (a) (continued)

The Elective 1 prescribed texts are:

- **Prose Fiction**
 - Aravind Adiga, *The White Tiger*
 - E M Forster, *A Passage to India*
 - Colm Tóibín, *Brooklyn*

- **Poetry**
 - Eileen Chong, *Burning Rice*

The prescribed poems are:

 - * *Burning Rice*
 - * *Mid-autumn Mooncakes*
 - * *My Hakka Grandmother*
 - * *Shophouse, Victoria Street*
 - * *Chinese Ginseng*
 - * *Winter Meeting*
 - * *Singapore*

- **Drama**
 - Andrew Bovell, *The Secret River* [by Kate Grenville – An adaptation for the stage by Andrew Bovell]

- **Film**
 - Sarah Gavron, *Brick Lane*

End of Question 2 (a)

OR

Question 2 (b) – Elective 2: Worlds of Upheaval (25 marks)

Read the stimulus provided below.

Evaluate how ideas in the stimulus relate to the increasingly complex, uncertain and/or changing worlds depicted in Worlds of Upheaval.

In your response, refer to TWO of your prescribed texts and ONE other text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts for Worlds of Upheaval are listed on page 9.

'One of the functions of art,' Ursula K. Le Guin observed in contemplating art, storytelling, and the power of language to transform and redeem, "is to give people the words to know their own experience... Storytelling is a tool for knowing who we are and what we want."

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Question 2 (b) continues on page 9

Question 2 (b) (continued)

The Elective 2 prescribed texts are:

- **Prose Fiction**
 - Elizabeth Gaskell, *North and South*
 - Mary Shelley, *Frankenstein*
 - Madeleine Thien, *Do Not Say We Have Nothing*
- **Poetry**
 - Seamus Heaney, *Opened Ground: Poems 1966–1996*

The prescribed poems are:

 - * *Digging*
 - * *The Strand at Lough Beg*
 - * *Casualty*
 - * *Funeral Rites*
 - * from *Whatever You Say Say Nothing*
 - * *Triptych*
- **Drama**
 - Samuel Beckett, *Waiting for Godot*
- **Film**
 - Fritz Lang, *Metropolis*

End of Question 2 (b)

OR

Question 2 (c) – Elective 3: Reimagined Worlds (25 marks)

Read the stimulus provided below.

Evaluate how ideas in the stimulus relate to the increasingly complex, uncertain and/or changing worlds depicted in Reimagined Worlds.

In your response, refer to TWO of your prescribed texts and ONE other text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts for Reimagined Worlds are listed on page 11.

“One of the functions of art,” Ursula K. Le Guin observed in contemplating art, storytelling, and the power of language to transform and redeem, “is to give people the words to know their own experience... Storytelling is a tool for knowing who we are and what we want.”

Because self-knowledge is the most difficult of the arts of living, because understanding ourselves is a prerequisite for understanding anybody else, and because we can hardly fathom the reality of another without first plumbing our own depths, art is what makes us not only human but humane.

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Question 2 (c) continues on page 11

Question 2 (c) (continued)

The Elective 3 prescribed texts are:

- **Prose Fiction**
 - Italo Calvino, *If on a Winter's Night a Traveller*
 - Ursula Le Guin, *The Left Hand of Darkness*
 - Jonathan Swift, *Gulliver's Travels*
- **Poetry**
 - Samuel Taylor Coleridge, *Samuel Taylor Coleridge: The Complete Poems*

The prescribed poems are:

 - * *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner* (1834)
 - * *The Eolian Harp*
 - * *Kubla Khan*
 - * *Christabel*
 - Tracy K Smith, *Life on Mars*

The prescribed poems are:

 - * *Sci-Fi*
 - * *My God, It's Full of Stars*
 - * *Don't You Wonder, Sometimes?*
 - * *The Universe: Original Motion Picture Soundtrack*
 - * *The Universe as Primal Scream*
- **Film**
 - Guillermo Del Toro, *Pan's Labyrinth*

End of Question 2 (c)

OR

Question 2 (d) – Elective 4: Literary Mindscapes (25 marks)

Read the stimulus provided below.

Evaluate how ideas in the stimulus relate to the increasingly complex, uncertain and/or changing worlds depicted in Literary Mindscapes.

In your response, refer to TWO of your prescribed texts and ONE other text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts for Literary Mindscapes are listed on page 13.

“One of the functions of art,” Ursula K. Le Guin observed in contemplating art, storytelling, and the power of language to transform and redeem, “is to give people the words to know their own experience... Storytelling is a tool for knowing who we are and what we want.”

Because self-knowledge is the most difficult of the arts of living, because understanding ourselves is a prerequisite for understanding anybody else, and because we can hardly fathom the reality of another without first plumbing our own depths, art is what makes us not only human but humane.

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Question 2 (d) continues on page 13

Question 2 (d) (continued)

The Elective 4 prescribed texts are:

- **Prose Fiction**
 - William Faulkner, *As I Lay Dying*
 - Gail Jones, *Sixty Lights*
 - Katherine Mansfield, *The Collected Stories*
 - * *Prelude*
 - * *Je ne Parle pas Français*
 - * *Bliss*
 - * *Psychology*
 - * *The Daughters of the Late Colonel*
- **Poetry**
 - Emily Dickinson, *The Complete Poems*

The prescribed poems are:

 - * *I felt a Funeral, in my Brain*
 - * *This is my letter to the World*
 - * *I died for Beauty – but was scarce*
 - * *I had been hungry, all the Years*
 - * *Because I could not stop for Death*
 - * *My Life has stood – a Loaded Gun*
 - * *A word dropped careless on a Page*
- **Drama**
 - William Shakespeare, *Hamlet*
- **Film**
 - Sofia Coppola, *Lost in Translation*

End of Question 2 (d)

OR

Question 2 (e) – Elective 5: Intersecting Worlds (25 marks)

Read the stimulus provided below.

Evaluate how ideas in the stimulus relate to the increasingly complex, uncertain and/or changing worlds depicted in Intersecting Worlds.

In your response, refer to TWO of your prescribed texts and ONE other text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts for Intersecting Worlds are listed on page 15.

“One of the functions of art,” Ursula K. Le Guin observed in contemplating art, storytelling, and the power of language to transform and redeem, “is to give people the words to know their own experience... Storytelling is a tool for knowing who we are and what we want.”

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Question 2 (e) continues on page 15

Question 2 (e) (continued)

The Elective 5 prescribed texts are:

- **Prose Fiction**
 - Melissa Harrison, *Clay*
 - Alex Miller, *Journey to the Stone Country*
 - Annie Proulx, *The Shipping News*
- **Nonfiction**
 - Tim Winton, *Island Home*
- **Poetry**
 - William Wordsworth, *William Wordsworth: The Major Works*

The prescribed poems are:

- * *Lines written a few miles above Tintern Abbey*
- * *Three years she grew in sun and shower*
- * *My heart leaps up when I behold*
- * *Resolution and Independence*
- * *The world is too much with us*
- * *Ode ('There was a time')*
- * *The Solitary Reaper*
- * *The Prelude* (1805) – Book One, lines 1–67, 271–441

- **Film**
 - Daniel Nettheim, *The Hunter*

End of Examination

EXAMINERS

Marilyn Pretorius (Convenor)
Peter Damalas
Debbie Hanrahan
Helen McCarthy
Kate O'Connor
Georgina Tsiftis
Jessica Whitney

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